Test 14:

READING PASSAGE 1

You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 1–13, which are based on Reading Passage 1 on pages 2 and 3.

Australia's Airborne Dentists

Australians living or travelling in rural and remote areas can face particular difficulties when they need medical care. Hundreds of kilometres from major cities and many hours by road from the closest hospital or clinic, some rural Australians do not have easy access to doctors, nurses and dentists.

Organisations such as the Royal Flying Doctor Service (RFDS) have been established to bring health services to outback Australian communities. The RFDS provides free medical care to people who live, work or travel in remote and regional parts of Australia.

This non-profit organisation is the oldest and largest airborne health service of its kind in the world, and since 1928 it has used small aircraft to send doctors and nurses to some of Australia's most far-away communities.

In recent years, the RFDS has also started to fly dentists to regional Australia. As well as offering mobile dental clinics, the RFDS offers a range of preventative and educational services.

Looking after the teeth of people in remote areas presents special challenges. These include providing care to disparate communities with no established dental facilities, and dealing with higher incidences of other diseases which are linked to, or caused by poor dental health.

People in remote areas have very infrequent visits by health staff. RFDS dentists might only visit a community once every few months, or sometimes once per year.

Because of infrequent dentist visits, patients in these areas often need to put up with their dental problems before they can get treatment; consequently, people in remote areas are more likely to have tooth decay (the blackening and deterioration of teeth) and develop gum and other mouth diseases.

In some locations that the RFDS visits, there are no suitable dental facilities, so dentists have to bring everything with them. This includes drills, dentists' chairs, portable X-ray machines, and computers for keeping track of patients' treatments.

Equipment can weigh up to 100 kilograms, and since the small planes that transport dentists have limited space, dentists cannot always bring everything that they need.

While dentists in town or city centres can specialise in certain types of treatment, RFDS dentists need to be "all-rounders". They need to be able to do all kinds of dental procedures, as they don't have the ability to refer patients to more specialised dentists.

Even with their broad experience, there are some services that are particularly challenging for RFDS dentists. For example, dentures (or artificial teeth) can be very difficult to provide, as they need to be the right shape and size for the patient, and this requires many visits over a long period of time. As a result, it is not practical to make dentures available.

Some chronic illnesses are more common in remote communities than in the rest of Australia. These illnesses can in turn lead to a lowered resistance to infection, including gum and other oral infections.

As a result, people in outback Australian communities are more likely to experience oral health problems than city folk, and this poses extra challenges for both the dentists and the doctors of the RFDS.

Because there aren't a lot of dental services in remote areas, people living in these areas also receive less education about good dental hygiene than their city counterparts do.

Australians in very remote communities might not be aware of things that people in cities take for granted, such as the importance of daily tooth brushing.

Also, basic dental hygiene items such as toothpaste and toothbrushes can be more expensive in outback areas. Many people are on low incomes, meaning they have extra difficulty affording these products. If this is the case, the RFDS supplies these.

As well as treating patients, RFDS dentists try to focus on preventative oral health and educate their patients on good oral hygiene, such as tooth brushing and flossing.

The RFDS also provides mouthguards for young sports players. Playing contact sports, such as rugby league or Australian rules football, can damage young people's teeth, so mouthguards provide protection which prevents accidental injuries.

Adding fluoride to water supplies has been proven to reduce the incidence of tooth decay in many parts of the world.

City dwellers in Australia use water supplies that have been fluoridated, and their rates of tooth decay are lower because of this.

In remote areas, it is not practical to fluoridate drinking water supplies, and so people living in these areas are more subject to tooth decay.

As a result, it is particularly important that people living in areas without fluoridated water pay special attention to regular brushing of their teeth with fluoridated toothpaste.

Despite many challenges, the RFDS continues to offer much-needed dental and medical support. Its presence in isolated communities greatly improves the quality of dental health, and supports important oral hygiene and health initiatives.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 1–7

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

In boxes 1–7 on your answer sheet, write:

TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

1. Many of the RFDS doctors work as volunteers.

2. RFDS dentists make trips to outback communities each month.

3. RFDS dentists are accompanied on their journeys to remote areas by a dental nurse.

4. RFDS dentists must provide a wide range of dental services.

5. Rural dental patients are more informed about oral hygiene than urban patients.

6. RFDS dentists educate patients about good eating habits.

7. Urban Australians generally have better teeth because their water is treated.

Questions 8–13

Complete the notes below.

Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.

Write your answers in boxes 8–13 on your answer sheet.

Challenges faced by RFDS dentists

- need to bring equipment including **8.** _____ for records
- aircraft used to carry equipment have restricted **9.** _____
- problems offering some services, e.g., fitting **10.** _____
- people in remote areas are more likely to have infection in their mouth

Products supplied by RFDS dentists if necessary:

RFDS provides:

- **11.** _____ and **12.** _____ for regular use
- **13.** _____ to protect teeth of sports players

ĐÁP ÁN:

1. NOT GIVEN

Đoạn chứa đáp án: Organisations such as the Royal Flying Doctor Service (RFDS) have been established to bring health services to outback Australian communities. The RFDS provides free medical care to people who live, work or travel in remote and regional parts of Australia. This non-profit organisation is the oldest and largest airborne health service of its kind in the world

(Các tổ chức như Dịch vụ Bác sĩ Bay Hoàng gia (RFDS) được thành lập để mang dịch vụ y tế đến các cộng đồng vùng sâu vùng xa của Úc. RFDS cung cấp dịch vụ chăm sóc y tế miễn phí cho những người sống, làm việc hoặc đi lại ở các vùng xa xôi và nông thôn của Úc. Tổ chức phi lợi nhuận này là dịch vụ y tế trên không lâu đời nhất và lớn nhất thuộc loại hình này trên thế giới.)

2. FALSE

Đoạn chứa đáp án: RFDS dentists might only visit a community once every few months, or sometimes once per year.

(Các nha sĩ của RFDS có thể chỉ đến thăm một cộng đồng vài tháng một lần, hoặc đôi khi chỉ một lần mỗi năm.)

3. NOT GIVEN

Đoạn chứa đáp án: In some locations that the RFDS visits, there are no suitable dental facilities, so dentists have to bring everything with them.

(Ở một số địa điểm mà RFDS đến thăm, không có cơ sở nha khoa phù hợp, vì vậy các nha sĩ phải mang theo mọi thứ cần thiết.)

4. TRUE

Đoạn chứa đáp án: They need to be able to do all kinds of dental procedures, as they don't have the ability to refer patients to more specialised dentists.

(Họ cần có khả năng thực hiện tất cả các loại thủ thuật nha khoa, vì họ không có khả năng giới thiệu bệnh nhân đến các nha sĩ chuyên khoa hơn.)

5. FALSE

Đoạn chứa đáp án: Because there aren't a lot of dental services in remote areas, people living in these areas also receive less education about good dental hygiene than their city counterparts do.

(Do các dịch vụ nha khoa ở vùng sâu vùng xa không nhiều, người dân sống ở những khu vực này cũng nhận được ít kiến thức về vệ sinh răng miệng tốt hơn so với người dân thành phố.)

6. NOT GIVEN

Đoạn chứa đáp án: RFDS dentists try to focus on preventative oral health and educate their patients on good oral hygiene, such as tooth brushing and flossing.

(Các nha sĩ thuộc RFDS cố gắng tập trung vào chăm sóc sức khỏe răng miệng phòng ngừa và giáo dục bệnh nhân về vệ sinh răng miệng tốt, chẳng hạn như đánh răng và dùng chỉ nha khoa.)

7. TRUE

Đoạn chứa đáp án: City dwellers in Australia use water supplies that have been fluoridated, and their rates of tooth decay are lower because of this.

(Người dân thành thị ở Úc sử dụng nguồn nước có chứa fluoride, và do đó tỷ lệ sâu răng của họ thấp hơn.)

8. computers

Đoạn chứa đáp án: This includes drills, dentists' chairs, portable X-ray machines, and computers for keeping track of patients' treatments.

(Điều này bao gồm máy khoan, ghế nha khoa, máy chụp X-quang di động và máy tính để theo dõi quá trình điều trị của bệnh nhân.)

9. space

Đoạn chứa đáp án: Equipment can weigh up to 100 kilograms, and since the small planes that transport dentists have limited space, dentists cannot always bring everything that they need.

(Thiết bị có thể nặng tới 100kg, và vì những chiếc máy bay nhỏ chuyên chở nha sĩ có không gian hạn chế, nên nha sĩ không phải lúc nào cũng mang theo tất cả những thứ họ cần.)

10. dentures

Đoạn chứa đáp án: For example, dentures (artificial teeth) can be very difficult to provide, as they need to be the right shape and size for the patient, and this requires many visits over a long period of time.

(Ví dụ, việc làm răng giả có thể rất khó khăn, vì chúng cần phải có hình dạng và kích thước phù hợp với bệnh nhân, và điều này đòi hỏi nhiều lần đến khám trong một thời gian dài.)

11. toothpaste

Đoạn chứa đáp án: Also, basic dental hygiene items such as toothpaste and toothbrushes can be more expensive in outback areas. Many people are on low incomes, meaning they have extra difficulty affording these products.

(Ngoài ra, các vật dụng vệ sinh răng miệng cơ bản như kem đánh răng và bàn chải đánh răng cũng có thể đắt hơn ở các vùng hẻo lánh. Nhiều người có thu nhập thấp, điều đó có nghĩa là họ gặp khó khăn hơn trong việc mua những sản phẩm này.)

12. toothbrushes

Đoạn chứa đáp án: Also, basic dental hygiene items such as toothpaste and toothbrushes can be more expensive in outback areas. Many people are on low incomes, meaning they have extra difficulty affording these products.

(Ngoài ra, các vật dụng vệ sinh răng miệng cơ bản như kem đánh răng và bàn chải đánh răng cũng có thể đắt hơn ở các vùng hẻo lánh. Nhiều người có thu nhập thấp, điều đó có nghĩa là họ gặp khó khăn hơn trong việc mua những sản phẩm này.)

13. mouthguards

Đoạn chứa đáp án: The RFDS also provides mouthguards for young sports players.

(RFDS cũng cung cấp dụng cụ bảo vệ răng miệng cho các vận động viên trẻ.)

IELTS

READING PASSAGE 2

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 14–26**, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.*

Mind Music

Scientists investigate 'earworms', the music we can't get out of our heads

A Ever had a song stuck in your head, playing on an endless loop? Scientists call them 'involuntary musical images', or 'earworms', and a wave of new research is shining light on why they occur and what can be learned from them. Some neuroscientists and cognitive psychologists are studying earworms to explore the mysteries of memory and the part of the brain that is beyond our conscious control. 'The idea that we have full control over our thought processes is an illusion,' says psychologist Lauren Stewart, who founded the master's program in music, mind and brain at Goldsmiths, University of London, UK, where recent research has taken place. Researchers haven't been able to watch what happens in the brain when earworms occur, because they happen unpredictably. Much of what is known about them comes from surveys, questionnaires, diaries and lab experiments.

B A Goldsmiths study published in the journal Memory and Cognition this year showed that the singing we hear in our heads tends to be true to actual recordings. Researchers had 17 volunteers tap to the beat of any earworm they heard during a four-day period while a device attached to their wrist recorded their movements. The tapping tempos were within 10% of the tempos of the original recordings. Another Goldsmiths study, published this year in Consciousness and Cognition, found that people who report hearing earworms often, and find them most intrusive, have slightly different brain structures, with more gray matter in areas associated with processing emotions.

C Studies also show that the music in our heads often starts playing during times of 'low cognitive load', such as while showering, getting dressed, walking, or doing chores. Dr Stewart likens earworms to 'sonic screen savers' that keep the mind entertained while it is otherwise unoccupied. She and her colleagues tested that theory by having volunteers listen to songs and giving them various tasks afterwards. The volunteers who sat idly for the next five minutes were the most likely to report hearing the music in their heads. Dr Stewart observed that the more challenging the activity, the less likely the volunteers were to hear the music. Diary studies also show songs tend to match people's moods and therefore they are not random. If you are energized and upbeat, an earworm that occurs is likely to be uptempo too.

D Songs the brain fixates on are usually those it has been exposed to recently, surveys show, which is why tunes getting heavy radio play frequently top the earworm charts. Even tunes you may have heard but didn't pay attention to can worm their way into your subconscious, says Ira Hyman, a psychologist at Western Washington University in Bellingham, USA. In an unpublished study there, participants who listened to music while doing other tasks were more likely to report that the songs returned as earworms later on, compared with participants who simply listened.

E Some earworms are just fragments of a song that repeat like a broken record. So, when the mind hits a part of a song it can't remember, it loops back rather than moving on. That could make an earworm even more entrenched, Dr Hyman says. According to a theory known as the Zeigarnik effect, named for a Soviet psychologist, Bluma Zeigarnik, unfinished thoughts and activities weigh on the mind more heavily than those that are completed, although experiments exposing students to interrupted songs have yielded mixed results.

F Researchers say they can't pinpoint a spot in the brain where earworms live. Imaging studies by Andrea Halpern at Bucknell University, in Lewisburg, USA, have shown that deliberately imagining music and actually listening to music activate many of the same neurological networks. Dr Halpern's earlier studies showed that when subjects listened to the first few notes of familiar music, areas in the right frontal and superior temporal portions of the brain became activated, along with the supplementary motor area at the top, which is typically involved in remembering sequences. When the same subjects listened to unfamiliar music and were asked to recall it, there was activity in the left frontal portions of the brain instead.

G One factor that makes some songs stick might be repetition. 'Repetition leads to familiarity which leads to anticipation, which is satisfied by hearing the song,' says John Seabrook, author of The Song Machine: Inside the Hit Factory, about how producers pump pop songs full of aural 'hooks', the punchy melodic phrases designed to target the brain and leave it wanting more. The researchers are comparing the melodic structure of 100 often mentioned songs with 100 similarly popular songs that weren't cited as earworms, to assess the difference. Songs with earworm potential appear to share certain features: a repeating pattern of ups and downs in pitch, and irregular musical intervals.

H The researchers plan next to test their results in reverse, and play ringtones from songs of both the earworm and non-earworm variety for volunteers several times a day to see which ones get stuck. Dr Stewart and Halpern are now working together to recruit survey participants for a study looking at whether people at different stages of life experience earworms differently. 'You can argue that older people might get them more often because they know more songs,' Dr Halpern says. 'But the few responses we have so far indicate that they have earworms less often. It could be that they don't play music as often as younger people do.'

Questions 14–17

Reading Passage 2 has eight paragraphs, ***A-H***

Which paragraph contains the following information?

Write the correct letter, ***A-H****, in boxes 14-17 on your answer sheet.*

14 a description of the characteristics common to songs with earworms

15 a justification for research into earworms

16 a description of the brain's reaction to known and unknown songs

17 details of proposed research into the frequency with which earworms occur in different age groups.

Questions 18–21

Complete the summary below.

Choose ***ONE WORD ONLY*** *from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 18-21 on your answer sheet.

Goldsmiths study

Researchers from Goldsmiths concluded that the music we imagine in our minds is quite similar to recordings. They proved this by asking volunteers to record the rhythm of music using a monitor on their **18** _____. Further research has demonstrated that those who hear earworms more frequently have brains that may deal with **19** _____ differently from other people, Dr Stewart also believes that the brain is **20** _____ by earworms when it is not focused on a task. In Fact, a reduction in the occurrence of earworms was found to be directly related to how **21** _____ the task was. Interestingly, volunteers' diaries revealed that the songs they heard inside their head reflected their moods, so the choice of music is not accidental.

Questions 22–26

Look at the following statements and the list of researchers below.

Match each statement with the correct person, ***A, B, C or D****.*

Write the correct letter ***A, B, C or D****, in boxes 22-26 on your answer sheet.*

NB *You may use any letter more than once.*

22 Some musicians create music that is intentionally memorable.

23 People are unable to completely regulate how they think

24 We can remember songs without knowing that we have heard them.

25 Thinking about music has a similar effect on the brain to hearing music.

26 Earworms are more persistent when only a short section of the song is constantly replayed.

List of Researchers

A Lauren Stewart
B Ira Hyman
C Andrea Halpern
D John Seabrook

TRUE IELTS

ĐÁP ÁN:

14. G: Mô tả các đặc điểm chung của các bài hát dễ gây ra "sâu tai" (earworms) như mẫu lặp lại của cao độ và khoảng cách âm nhạc không đều.

15. A: Đưa ra lý do cho việc nghiên cứu earworms là để khám phá những bí ẩn của trí nhớ và phần não bộ nằm ngoài sự kiểm soát có ý thức.

16. F: Mô tả phản ứng của não bộ đối với các bài hát quen thuộc (kích hoạt vùng trán phải) và không quen thuộc (kích hoạt vùng trán trái).

17. H: Chi tiết về nghiên cứu dự kiến đối với tần suất xuất hiện earworms ở các nhóm tuổi khác nhau.

18. wrist: Các tình nguyện viên đeo một thiết bị trên **cổ tay** (wrist) để ghi lại nhịp điệu khi họ nghe thấy earworms.

19. emotions: Những người thường xuyên gặp earworms có cấu trúc não xử lý **cảm xúc** (emotions) khác với người bình thường.

20. entertained: Tiến sĩ Stewart tin rằng não bộ được **giải trí** (entertained) bởi earworms khi nó không tập trung vào một nhiệm vụ cụ thể.

21. challenging: Sự xuất hiện của earworms giảm đi tỷ lệ thuận với mức độ **thách thức** (challenging) của công việc đang làm.

22. D (John Seabrook): Đề cập đến việc các nhà sản xuất tạo ra các "aural hooks" (móc câu âm thanh) để bài hát trở nên dễ nhớ một cách có ý đồ.

23. A (Lauren Stewart): Cho rằng ý tưởng con người có toàn quyền kiểm soát quá trình suy nghĩ chỉ là một ảo tưởng.

24. B (Ira Hyman): Phát biểu rằng ngay cả những giai điệu bạn nghe mà không chú ý cũng có thể len lỏi vào tiềm thức.

25. C (Andrea Halpern): Chứng minh rằng việc tưởng tượng về âm nhạc và thực sự nghe nhạc kích hoạt nhiều mạng lưới thần kinh giống nhau.

26. B (Ira Hyman): Giải thích rằng earworms trở nên dai dẳng hơn khi tâm trí chỉ lặp đi lặp lại một đoạn ngắn của bài hát mà nó không thể nhớ hết.

TRUE IELTS

READING PASSAGE 3

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27–40**, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

How to clean a beach

Oil spills such as the disaster in the Gulf of Mexico serve to remind us of the potential dangers of various commercial activities for our fragile oceanic environments

After the oil-tanker Prestige spilt her cargo just off north-west Spain in November 2002, the beautiful beaches of the Galician coastline were a metre deep in a mixture of oil and sea water. The Prestige was only one incident in a long series of accidents involving oil tankers. But while each new incident, including that of Prestige, brings environmental destruction and financial loss, it also improves our understanding of how to deal with oil spills. This knowledge is hard-won as people have often learned from mistakes made in dealing with oil spills. Aggressive clean-ups have sometimes caused more damage than the oil. But such difficulties apart, a rough consensus on how to deal with the issues involved in clearing up oil spills has begun to emerge.

Oil is much less damaging at sea than on shore, so the best option is to skim the spilled oil off the surface of the water using specially equipped ships. A series of wooden booms floating on the surface of the water can also be used to protect the coastline. But the sea around the Prestige was too rough for the former, and much of the coast too exposed for booms to work, so there was little that could be done except watch the oil wash up onto the beaches.

When oil arrives onshore, the question becomes how best to save affected plants and animals, while minimizing damage to the surrounding ecosystem, without running up a huge bill. In large spills, leaving nature to do the job is a bad idea. Even the oiliest shore will return to normal, but without human intervention this can take many years. In the case of the Prestige, both the volume of oil spilt and the wildlife, fishing and tourist value of the Galician coast demanded action by specialists.

To decide what to do, specialists combined their own professional experience with local knowledge in an assessment process known as ‘net environmental benefit analysis’. Factors taken into account include possible environmental destruction, such as to an oiled beach which is home to a breeding colony of seals or seabirds. Less immediate socio-economic repercussions also come into play: local people may rely on shellfish beds, for example, or an affected beach could be a tourist destination. And such practical realities as the cost incurred by a particular cleanup option and how easy it will be to implement are also assessed.

Every intensive clean-up option has its drawbacks. When oil from the Exxon Valdez polluted the Alaskan shoreline in 1989, hot water applied under high pressure was used to scrub the beaches. But the parts of the shoreline that got this treatment recovered more slowly than those that did not. In Spain, this technique has so far been used only on man-made structures such as harbour walls.

Other methods have been even more aggressive than this. When the Torrey Canyon ran aground off the south coast of England in March 1967, oiled beaches were treated with 10,000 tonnes of chemical sprays. These turned out to be more toxic than the oil: many seashore invertebrates died, and the nutrients in the dispersants caused an explosion of seaweed growth.

In Galicia, local people wanted heavy machinery to come in and remove large quantities of oil quickly. But this has its own environmental cost. There were no tracks to the worst-affected beaches and it was feared that building them would harm the surrounding landscape. But in one of the areas affected, oil on the surface of the beaches was likely to be washed into the pipe that supplied water to a large fish farm. In the end, the desire to safeguard the farm tipped the balance in favour of building tracks for bulldozers and earthmovers, which scooped up the oil from the beach. Such equipment was not used in all areas affected by the Prestige spill, however. Salt-marshes and estuaries are such delicate terrain that almost any activity does more damage than the oil.

After the Amoco Cadiz disaster in 1978, when nearly a quarter of a million tonnes of oil were spilt off the coast of north-west France, heavy equipment was sent in to some polluted salt-marshes, where it scraped up the top half-metre of sediment. Twelve years later, these areas had still not recovered, whereas the oiled marshes that went uncleaned seemed in good shape.

After a short period of time the Prestige spill moved from the emergency phase – high profile, high pressure – to a long-term painstaking project. Cleaning the beaches, for example, was a huge task. At Carnota, one of the most heavily affected areas of Galicia, dozens of volunteers and soldiers worked their way along six kilometres of sand on hands and knees, scraping up the small lumps of solidified oil. At other beaches nearby, people sifted the sand and combed seaside plants by hand to remove the oil and stop it becoming buried.

Once workers there had done all they could, stubborn patches still remained on rocks and in crevices. A possibility was to move oily rocks down the beach into the surf since this accelerates the natural cleaning process, as can ‘flushing’ – i.e. pumping sea water over the shore and sifting the oil out of the run-off. But as the coastline became cleaner, the clean-up started to cost more for progressively less reward and more environmental damage. The Galicians were then faced with perhaps their most difficult decision: when to stop. As with most such operations, this decision is usually taken by local politicians rather than by environmentalists.

Questions 27–31

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 27–31 on your answer sheet, write

YES — if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer
NO — if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer
NOT GIVEN — if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

27 In the case of the Prestige financial loss was avoided.

28 The ideal solution to oil spills at sea is to stop the oil from reaching the shore.

29 Wooden booms have to be put in place immediately in order to be effective.

30 More action could have been taken to prevent oil from the Prestige reaching the Galician shoreline.

31 In environmental incidents it is considered more important to protect wild animals than plants.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 32–36

Complete the summary below.

*Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 32–36 on your answer sheet.

Net environmental benefit analysis

In this process, decisions about environmental incidents are made by specialists, but **32** _____ is also taken into account. The factors that are considered include destruction of the environment, more long-term **33** _____ aspects such as the effect on tourism, and practical matters that may be linked to the **34** _____ of various clean-up methods.

Several types of intensive clean-up operations have been used in different parts of the world. These include the use of **35** _____ in Alaska and of **36** _____ in England, as well as the employment of heavy machinery in France.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 37–40

Choose the correct letter, ***A, B, C or D****.*

Write the correct letter in boxes 37–40 on your answer sheet.

37 Heavy machinery was used in one part of Galicia

A to improve the appearance of the landscape.
B to purify domestic water supplies.
C to allow access to agricultural areas.
D to protect the local farming industry.

38 The main lesson learned from the Amoco Cadiz disaster was that in environmentally sensitive areas

A attempts to clean up oil may prevent effective recovery.
B more than twenty years is needed for the land to recover.
C thorough treatment is needed if areas are to recover.
D every trace of sediment must be removed for a full recovery.

39 The writer says that at Camota and similar beaches nearby

A some areas have been completely cleared of oil traces.
B sea water can be used to remove patches of oil on the rocks.
C the large pieces of rock have to be cleaned using machinery.
D only highly skilled people can help in the cleaning operation.

40 Which of the following best summarises the views put forward by the writer in this passage?

A It would be preferable to prevent oil spills from happening in the first place.
B There is no single or complete solution to the problem of oil spills.
C The main factor preventing the effective clearing of oil spills is lack of funding.
D Environmental considerations should be a low priority when coping with oil spills.

ĐÁP ÁN:

27. In the case of the Prestige, financial loss was avoided.

→ NO

“each new incident, including that of Prestige, brings environmental destruction and financial loss” (Para. 2)

Bài nói thẳng là có tổn thất tài chính.

28. The ideal solution to oil spills at sea is to stop the oil from reaching the shore.

→ YES

“Oil is much less damaging at sea than on shore, so the best option is to skim the spilled oil off the surface of the water using specially equipped ships.” (Para. 3)

“Best option” = lấy dầu ra khỏi mặt nước trước khi vào bờ → tức là ngăn dầu chạm bờ là lý tưởng nhất.

29. Wooden booms have to be put in place immediately in order to be effective.

→ NOT GIVEN

“A series of wooden booms floating on the surface of the water can also be used to protect the coastline.” (Para. 3)

Bài chỉ nói booms có thể dùng để bảo vệ bờ biển, không đề cập gì đến yếu tố thời gian.

30. More action could have been taken to prevent oil from the Prestige reaching the Galician shoreline.

→ NO

“the sea around the Prestige was too rough for the former, and much of the coast too exposed for booms to work, so there was little that could be done except watch the oil wash up onto the beaches.” (Para. 3)

Bài nói rõ là “hầu như không thể làm gì” — không phải là có thể làm thêm mà không làm.

31. In environmental incidents it is considered more important to protect wild animals than plants.

→ NOT GIVEN

“the question becomes how best to save affected plants and animals, while minimizing damage to the surrounding ecosystem” (Para. 4)

Bài đặt cả cây và động vật ngang nhau, không ưu tiên loại nào hơn.

32. → local knowledge

“specialists combined their own professional experience with local knowledge in an assessment process known as ‘net environmental benefit analysis’.” (Para. 5)

Câu hỏi nói “decisions are made by specialists, but 32… is also taken into account” → đúng là local knowledge.

33. → socio-economic

“Less immediate socio-economic repercussions also come into play: local people may rely on shellfish beds, for example, or an affected beach could be a tourist destination.” (Para. 5)

Câu hỏi nói “more long-term 33… aspects such as the effect on tourism” → khớp hoàn toàn.

34. → cost

“such practical realities as the cost incurred by a particular cleanup option and how easy it will be to implement are also assessed.” (Para. 5)

Câu hỏi: “practical matters that may be linked to the 34… of various clean-up methods.”

35. → hot water

“When oil from the Exxon Valdez polluted the Alaskan shoreline in 1989, hot water applied under high pressure was used to scrub the beaches.” (Para. 6)

Câu hỏi: “use of 35… in Alaska.”

36. → chemical sprays

“oiled beaches were treated with 10,000 tonnes of chemical sprays. These turned out to be more toxic than the oil.” (Para. 7)

Câu hỏi: “36… in England” → vụ Torrey Canyon, Anh 1967.

37. → D (to protect the local farming industry)

“oil on the surface of the beaches was likely to be washed into the pipe that supplied water to a large fish farm. In the end, the desire to safeguard the farm tipped the balance in favour of building tracks for bulldozers.” (Para. 8)

Đáp án D “protect the local farming industry” = bảo vệ fish farm. A sai (không phải cảnh quan), B sai (không phải nước sinh hoạt), C sai (không phải nông nghiệp chung).

38. → A (attempts to clean up oil may prevent effective recovery)

“heavy equipment was sent in to some polluted salt-marshes, where it scraped up the top half-metre of sediment. Twelve years later, these areas had still not recovered, whereas the oiled marshes that went uncleaned seemed in good shape.” (Para. 9)

Khu dọn dẹp máy móc → 12 năm chưa hồi phục. Khu không dọn → vẫn ổn. → Dọn dẹp có thể cản trở quá trình phục hồi tự nhiên.

39. → B (sea water can be used to remove patches of oil on the rocks)

“A possibility was to move oily rocks down the beach into the surf since this accelerates the natural cleaning process, as can ‘flushing’ — i.e. pumping sea water over the shore and sifting the oil out of the run-off.” (Para. 11)

A sai (vẫn còn “stubborn patches”), C sai (không dùng máy cho đá), D sai (không đề cập kỹ năng cao).

40. → B (There is no single or complete solution to the problem of oil spills)

“a rough consensus on how to deal with the issues involved in clearing up oil spills has begun to emerge… Every intensive clean-up option has its drawbacks.” (Para. 2 & 6)